

MUHAMMAD SHAYAN GUL

Cybersecurity Student — CEH Certified | Ethical Hacking, Defensive Security, Cloud & Automation

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PROFILE

Final-year BSc Cybersecurity student at Howest and Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH), currently working towards CompTIA Security+. My coursework and team projects cover both sides of security: attacking systems in pentests, and building, hardening and monitoring them so attacks get caught. I have run a full internal IT/OT penetration test with a client-style report, assessed Android apps with Frida and Burp Suite, deployed monitored honeypots with ELK, Splunk and Wazuh, and worked with Windows and Linux servers, firewalls and AWS, Azure and GCP labs. I write Python and Bash and use Ansible to automate scanning, server configuration and repetitive checks. I am looking for a security team where I can contribute to testing, detection and automation while I keep learning. Available for a full-time 6-month internship (Howest agreement available).

EDUCATION

BSc Cybersecurity

2024 – 2027 (expected)

Howest University of Applied Sciences, Bruges, Belgium

- Core coursework: Web & Mobile Pentesting, Network & System Pentesting, Blue Teaming & Incident Response, Digital Forensics, Reverse Engineering & Malware Analysis, Server Security, Data Centre & Cloud Security, Cryptography, IoT Security, GDPR and risk management.

Software Engineering (1 year)

2022 – 2023

Foundation University, Pakistan

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) — EC-Council

Issued 4 September 2026 | Certificate No. ECC0594781236

- Learned:** the full attacker workflow (recon, scanning, enumeration, exploitation, covering tracks) and the defences against each step, including AI-assisted security techniques, so I know which weaknesses are really exploitable and which fixes come first.
- Verify:** enter my name and certificate number at aspen.eccouncil.org/verify.

CyberOps Associate — Cisco Networking Academy

Completed 6 October 2026

- Covered:** security monitoring, host-based analysis, network intrusion analysis, and security policies and incident-response procedures, the core of an entry-level SOC analyst's work.
- Verify:** certificate ID af7530ae-6071-431d-8a8c-b440cdb46738 (issued under the name Shayan Gul Muhammad).

CompTIA Security+

In progress

- Covering:** security operations, risk management, cryptography, identity and access, incident response.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Network & System Pentesting — Internal IT/OT Environment

Team project, Howest

- Full internal test of a simulated IT/OT network with Nmap, Metasploit, Burp Suite, Nessus/OpenVAS and Wireshark, from recon to reporting. Found and validated 24 vulnerabilities (6 critical), including an unauthenticated OS command injection (CVSS 9.8) and exposed Elasticsearch, iSCSI, SMB, FTP and DNS services.
- Value:** I can find real risks in a network and write them up (CVSS, CWE, risk matrix, fixes) so managers and engineers both know what to do next.

Web Security, Honeypots & Monitoring

Team project, Howest

- Built and hardened a web app (login, profiles, admin panel) with Nginx, Apache and HAProxy, plus a web honeypot and a second one on a non-standard port. Pentested other teams' setups with OWASP methods. Sent logs through ELK, Filebeat and Kibana; used Splunk and Wazuh for alert triage and source-IP investigation.
- Value:** I can help a SOC or blue team spot suspicious activity, judge how serious it is, and document the incident.

System & Security Automation — Ansible

Individual project

- Configured automation for multiple servers with Ansible: inventory and playbooks run over SSH to apply configuration and security settings the same way on every machine, with SSH-based automation for the repetitive administration tasks around it.
- Value:** I can turn manual server setup and security checks into repeatable, documented automation that saves time and reduces mistakes.

Android Mobile Security Assessment

Mobile security, Howest

- Static and dynamic analysis of an Android app on a rooted emulator with JADX, Apktool, ADB, Logcat, Frida and Burp Suite: decompiling, insecure credential storage, root-detection logic, API access control and a Frida runtime bypass of an admin check.
- Value:** I can test a mobile app from both the attacker side and the defender side.

Digital Forensics Labs

Howest

- Investigated attacker logon activity in Windows Security event logs (Event ID 4624), with timeline analysis, Registry artifacts and file carving using Autopsy, Sleuth Kit, Plaso, KAPE and Velociraptor.

Cloud, Server & Firewall Security Labs

Howest

- Worked with AWS, Azure, Google Cloud and VMware/ESXi (cloud networking, IAM, security groups) and Entra ID. Configured Windows Server, Active Directory, GPO, LAPS and Linux hardening. Configured Palo Alto Networks, Cisco, pfSense and OPNsense firewalls (policies, NAT, traffic filtering, VLAN segmentation) with OpenVPN and WireGuard.
- Value:** I can help set up and check cloud and on-prem environments so they are secure from the start.

Security Toolkit — 8 Python Security Tools

Scripting & Code Analysis coursework

- VirusTotal URL checker, port scanner, Paramiko SSH automation, password analyzer, web scraper, MAC spoofer, service comparator and a controlled load-testing tool. Used Git, GitLab CI/CD and Docker.
- Value:** I can automate scanning, lookups and reporting that would otherwise be done by hand.

Tesla Autonomous Parking Challenge — 1st Prize

Fontys University, Netherlands

- Worked with Tesla's software engineers, as part of a team, on a real problem Tesla was facing: designed a working autonomous-parking prototype, proposed a solution and won 1st prize against other universities.
- Value:** I can work with industry engineers on a real problem, deliver under a deadline and work well in mixed teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive: Nmap, Metasploit (Kali Linux), Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nessus, OpenVAS, Wireshark, Frida, JADX, Apktool, ADB, John the Ripper, web & mobile pentesting, OWASP Top 10, CVSS/CWE reporting

Defensive & Forensics: Splunk, Wazuh, ELK, Suricata, Sysmon, incident response, Cowrie honeypot, MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001, GDPR, Autopsy, Sleuth Kit, Plaso, KAPE, Velociraptor, Registry analysis, file carving, malware analysis

Network & Firewalls: Palo Alto Networks, Cisco, pfSense, OPNsense, firewall policies, NAT, VLANs, OpenVPN, WireGuard, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP

Cloud & Systems: AWS, Azure, GCP, Entra ID, VMware/ESXi, Proxmox (incl. nested), Kubernetes (Talos Linux), Windows Server, Active Directory, Linux, Docker

Automation: Ansible (playbooks, inventory, SSH automation), Python (API integration, scripting), Bash, PowerShell, Git, GitLab CI/CD

AI & LLM SKILLS

Models & tools: Claude and Claude Code, ChatGPT, DeepSeek, Kimi, Perplexity and other assistants, chosen per task.

LLMs: studied how LLMs work, with their limits and security risks. Hosted applications on local models with Ollama.

LANGUAGES

Languages: English (fluent, IELTS 8.5), Urdu (native), Dutch (learning), French (beginner)